

**We all crave
being
understood.**

**Let's commit
to listen.**

Presented by Vyacheslav Ladischenski (Slava)

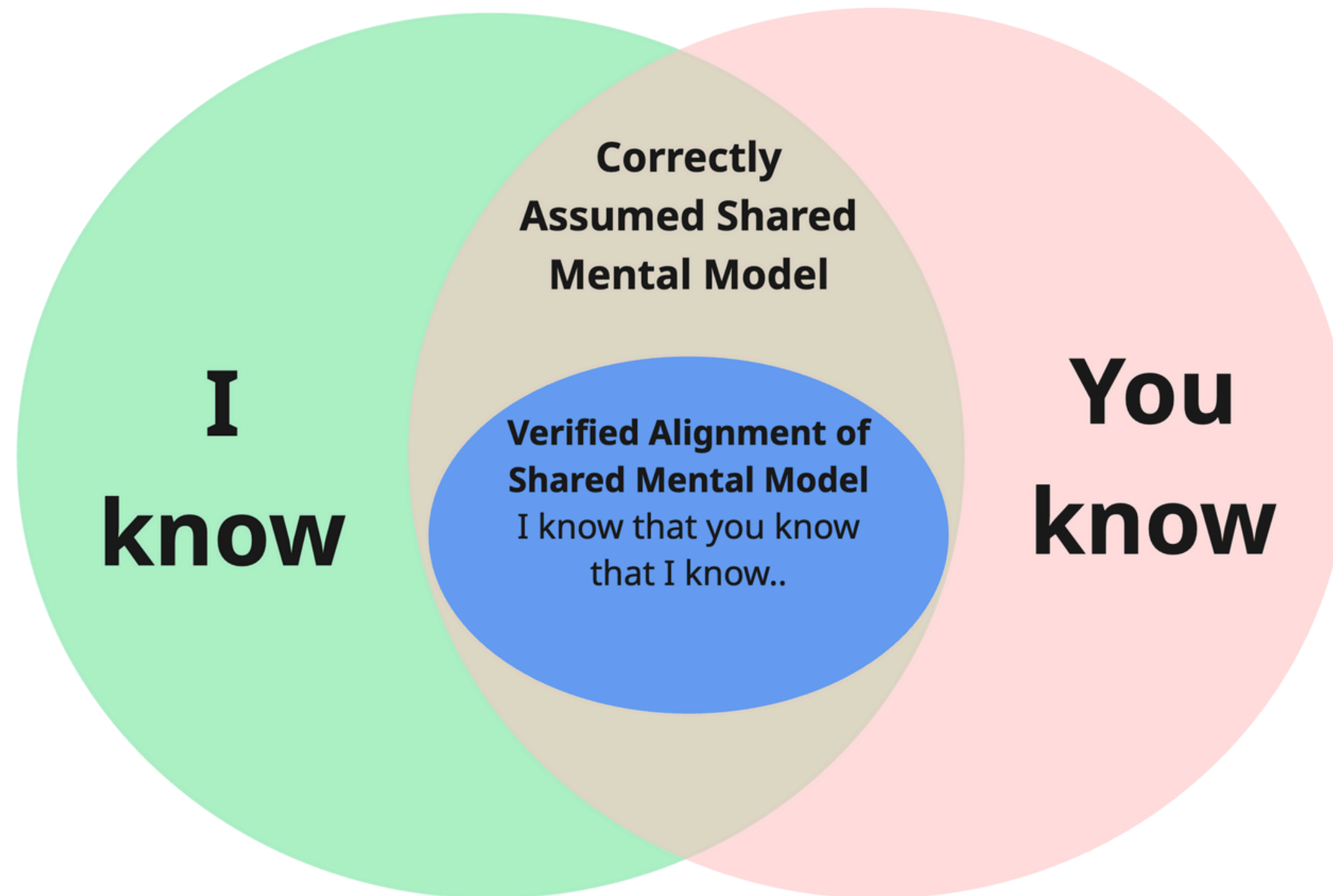
ACTIVE LISTENING

**FINDING CLARITY THROUGH
UNDERSTANDING**



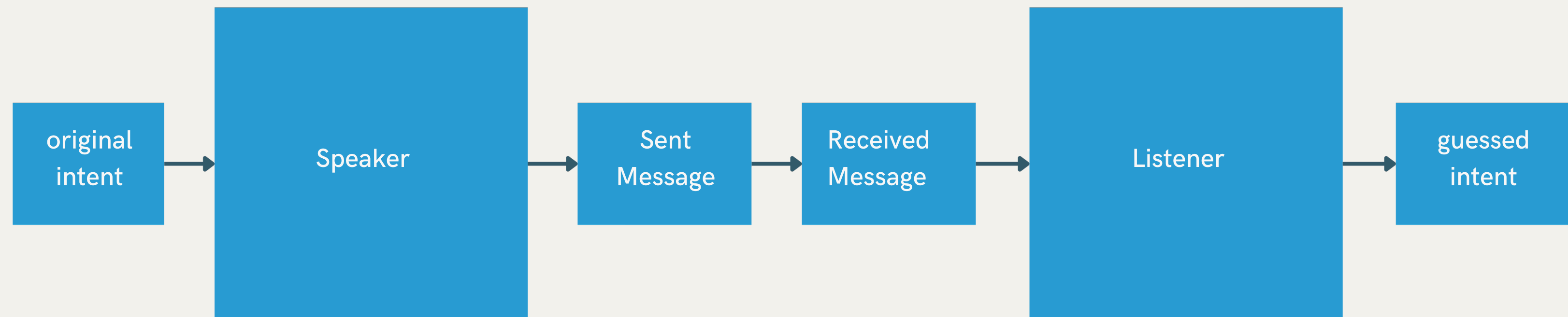
**4SEAS NIMMAN
WEDNESDAY, DECEMBER 10
3:00 PM – 5:00 PM**

Wrongly Assumed Alignment of Mental Model (WAMM)



Root Cause for WAMM

Lack of respect for the Asymmetry of Vulnerability: The Speaker is more vulnerable. The Listener's unregulated emotions create a risk of judgment, which forces the Speaker into silence.



Sender-Receiver Communication Model

Negative Externality

It is the systemic cost when an actor's action imposes a negative outcome on their environment.

Problem

The **Illusion of Shared Reality** leads to everyone paying the **Clarity Tax**

Clarity Tax arises when an individual refuses to verify mutual understanding, and it causes the failure of a group to coordinate their actions.

Problem

The failure to reliably uncover **wrongly assumed shared mental model** leads to a **false consensus, and false disagreements**

Evidence from Business

80%

of leaders believe
they are understood

50%

of employees agree they
truly understand

44%

of employees withhold
sharing their
disagreements

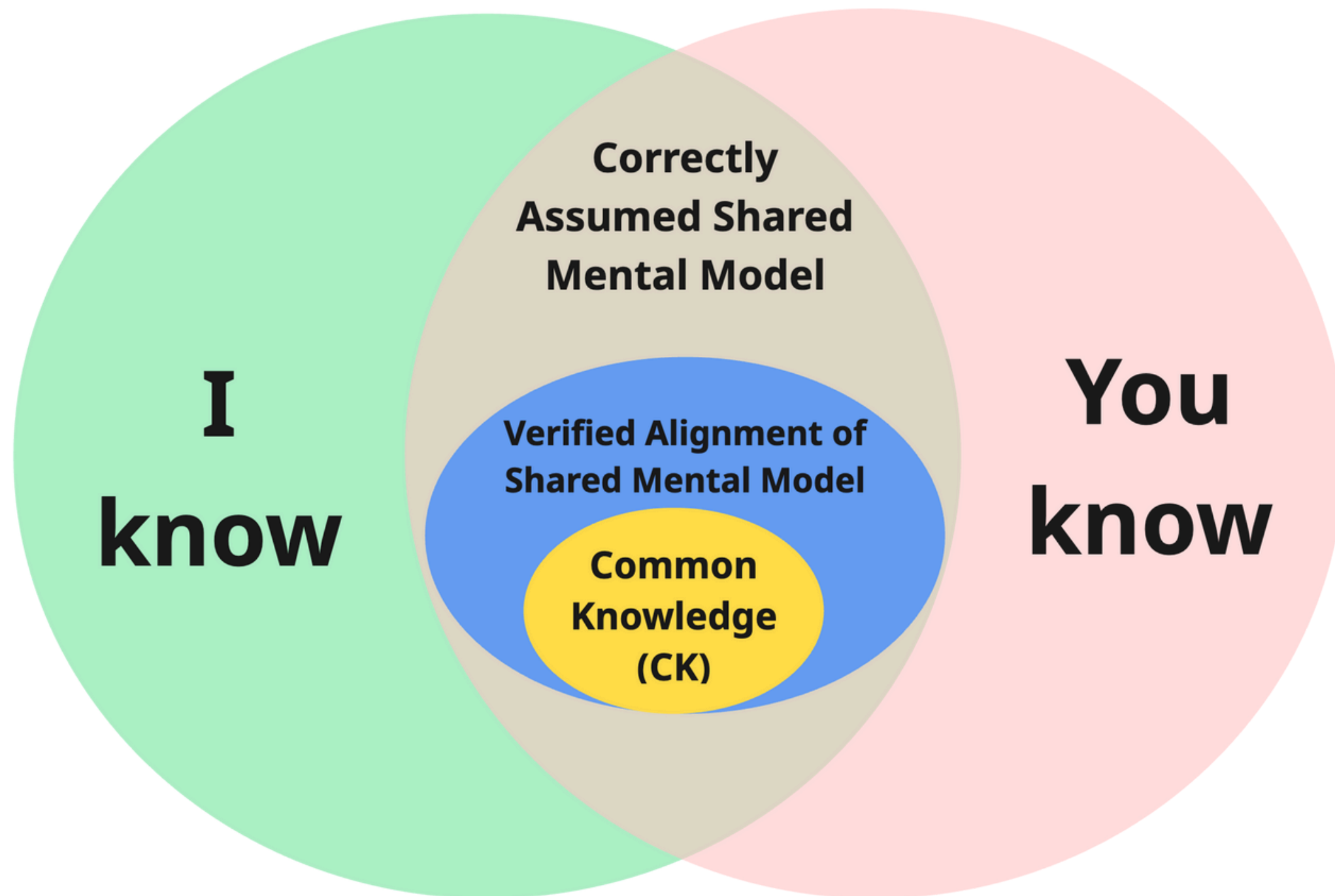
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broken
communication cost
annually in U.S.
economic losses

Sources: Grammarly/Harris Poll; Columbia Business School/Stanford Study, AxiosHQ Study

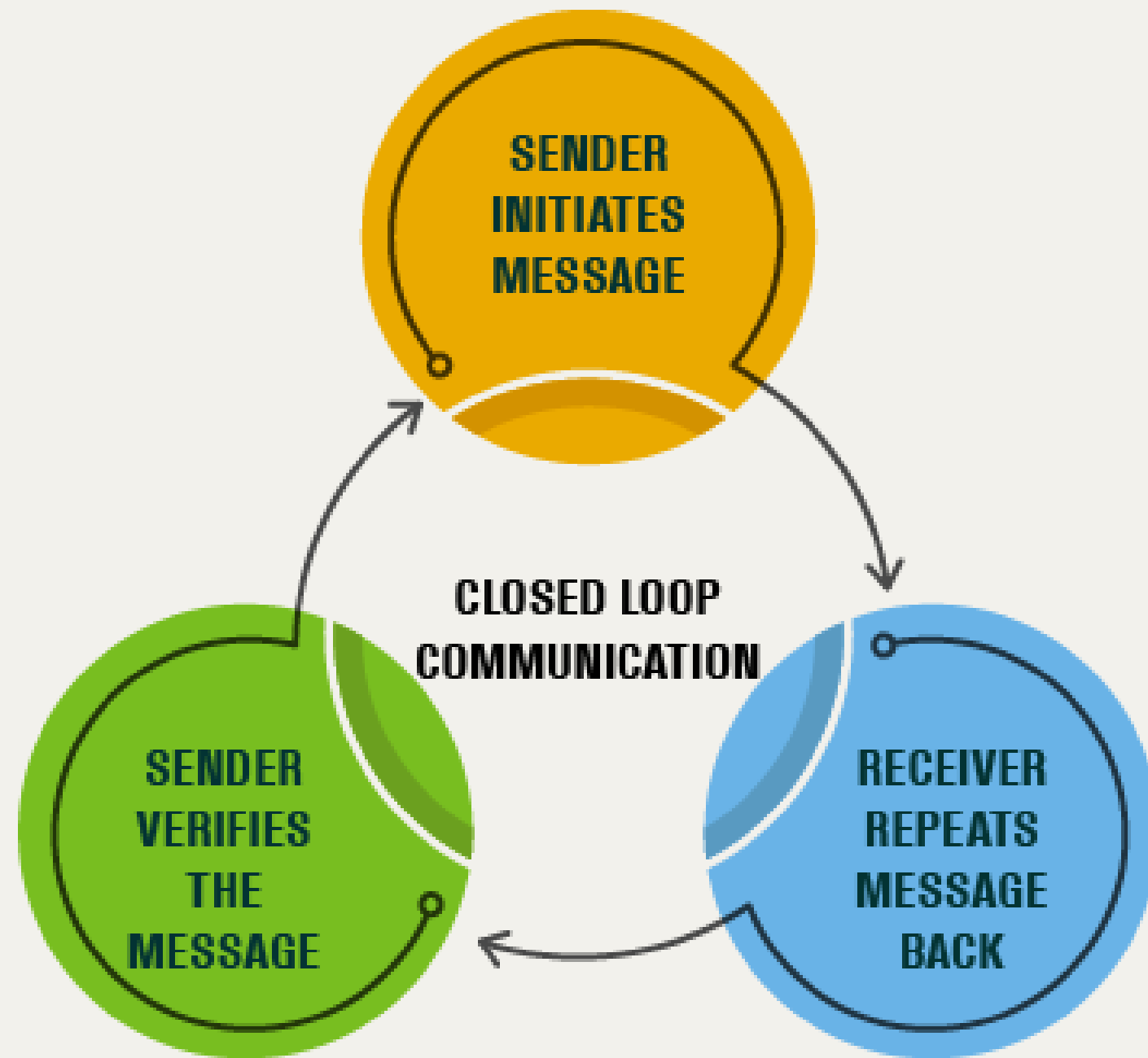
Common Knowledge (CK)

The most valuable CK is how to reliably create CK



Closed-Loop Communication (CLC)

The most reliable method to create Common Knowledge (CK)



- Aviation: Avoids Catastrophic Accidents
- Medicine: 47% fewer complications
- Psychotherapy: #1 success predictor
- Complex Sales: Top Skill to Influence Customers
- Leadership: Ensures Psychological Safety for Team

Why people refuse CLC requests?

Lack of Will: Ignorance, Incentives & Cognitive Biases & Flaws

EGO

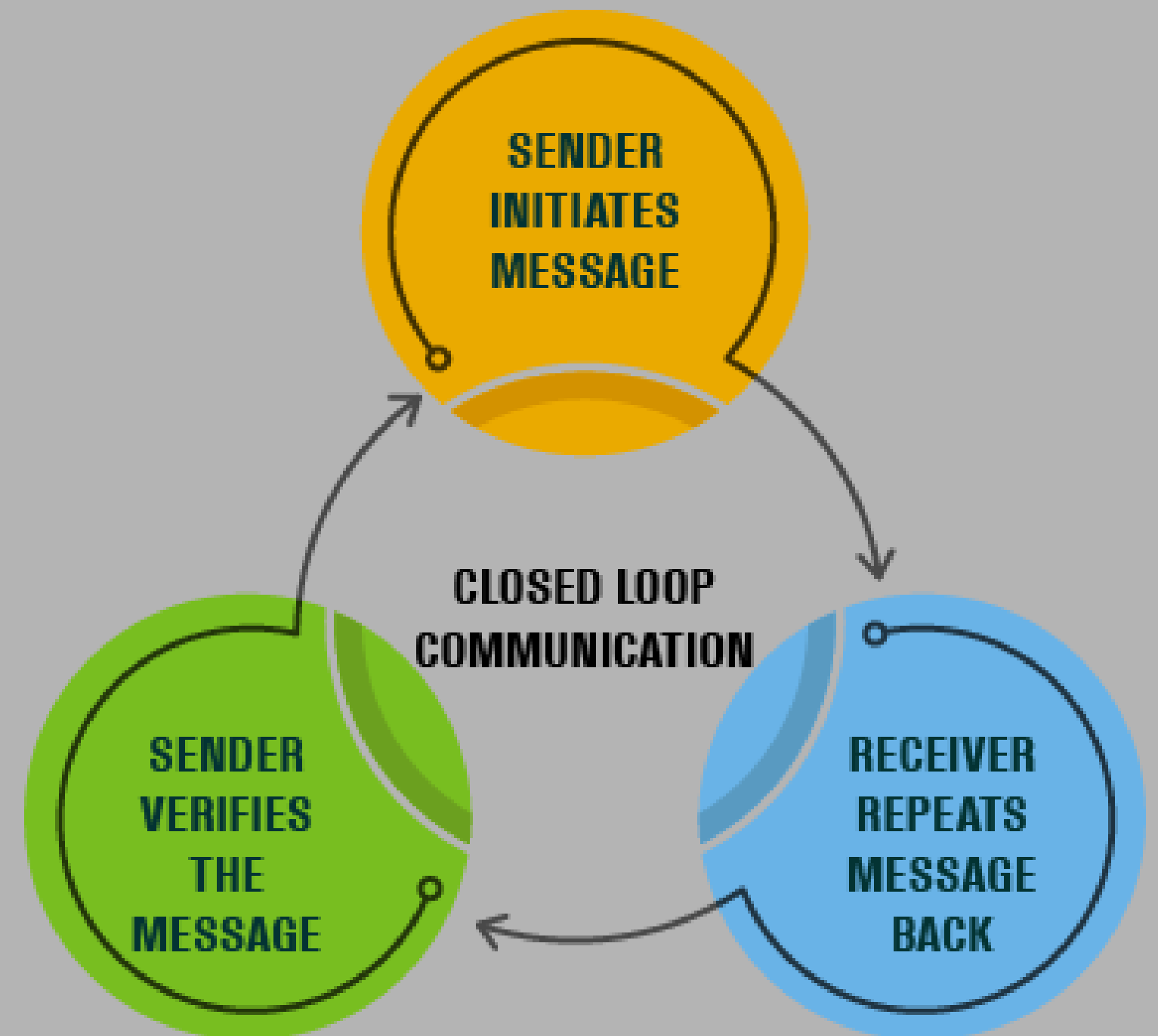
avoids taking the risk of exposing a potential error in understanding, which is driven by **Fear** of appearing incompetent.

LAZINESS

avoids effort and skips the mental work required for active listening and clarification

FEAR

shifts accountability to preserve the opportunity to blame the partner for unclear communication, which is driven by strategic **Self-preservation**.



Clarity Principle

It institutionalizes CLC as the **most reliable method** to create CK and enforces respect for **Assymetry of Vulnerability**

YOUR RIGHT

When we talk, if you need to check whether I understood your idea in the way you meant it, please ask me to explain back to you how I understood it.

MY PROMISE

I promise to try to explain back what I think you meant without judgment or criticism so you can confirm or correct my understanding. If I cannot follow this promise, I will explain why.

Clarity Principle

It institutionalizes CLC as the **most reliable method** to create CK and enforces respect for **Assymetry of Vulnerability**

- *When we talk, if you need to verify I received your message in the way you meant it, please **ask me to repeat it in my own words.***
- *I promise to try to state it back **without judgment or criticism,** so you can easily confirm or correct my understanding.*
- *If I'm unable to repeat it back, I will **explain why.***

Forcing Aumann's Theorem

- The Clarity Check (f_{CLC}) is the forcing function that satisfies the "Common Knowledge" precondition of Aumann's Theorem.
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- Now, if we still disagree, we know it is not because of "misunderstanding" (Epistemic Noise).
- It must be because of Different Priors (Values/Axioms) or Irrationality.
- Value: This strips away the 80% of noise ("I thought you meant X") so we can focus on the 20% of true conflict ("I value Safety, you value Freedom").
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- Does CLC change Priors?
- Directly? No. CLC is a mirror, not a hammer. It reflects understanding; it doesn't force conversion.
- Indirectly? Yes. Often, what we think are "Deep Priors" (immutable values) are actually just Hardened Misunderstandings.
- Example: I hate "Nuclear Power" (Prior).
- Why? Because I believe "Nuclear Power = Atomic Bomb" (Mental Model).
- CLC Intervention: You explain the difference. I paraphrase it back. I now have Verified Alignment that a reactor cannot explode like a bomb.
- Result: My "Prior" (I hate Nuclear) dissolves because it was built on a False Model.
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- CLC fixes Information Asymmetry (The easiest part).
- CLC exposes Irrationality (The social part).
- CLC challenges Priors (The long-term part).
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Rewiring of Social Hierarchy

Once CLC is recognized as the most reliable method for creating CK, it fundamentally changes the social hierarchy.

It rewires an organization from a Hierarchy of Authority
to a Hierarchy of Clarity and Intellectual Integrity

Next Steps

1. Workshops with the Alignment Gap Test to increase the Will to follow the Clarity Principle
2. Public Pledge Platform
3. Clarity Governance Platform

Last step before you join the meeting

✓ Review and Commit to Clarity Agreement

[Why do I see this?](#) ▾

MY RIGHT

I am empowered to ask any meeting participant to **repeat back in their own words** how they understand my critical ideas.

MY COMMITMENT

When others ask me, I will **try to repeat back** my understanding of their idea **without judgment or criticism**, so they can confirm or correct my understanding. If I'm unable to follow my commitment, I will explain why.

✓ Commit & Join Meeting

[Join meeting without commitment](#)

Clarity AI Assistant will help us celebrate our collective effort to achieve alignment

Meeting Details

Vyacheslav Ladischenski Host

Andreas & Slava

November 7, 2025
1:00 PM - 2:00 PM CEST

[Google Meet](#)

Participants & Commitments

	Vyachesla... Host	Committed
	Andreas Studer	Pending
	Marcus Rodriguez	Committed
	Emily Watson	Committed
	David Kim	Pending
	Lisa Martinez	Pending
	James Tho...	No Commitment

A Call for Research Collaboration



Vyacheslav Ladischenski
slava@inguro.com

Agenda

1. Problem
2. Root Cause
3. Solution
4. Vision
5. Next steps

Thesis

Desinformation and **ideological polarization** cause a
Loss of Shared Reality and **democratic decline**